- Binary safety
- Cryptography
- Regular expressions
- Language extensions

Making and Manipulating Strings

Strings are everywhere in this book; you'll have already seen many examples of their use, but let's get the formalities out of the way in one place. The basic syntax for creating string literals is straightforward. There are four ways to do it: single-quoted, double-quoted, *heredoc*, and *nowdoc*. Let's look at quoted strings first.

Quoted Strings

```
$str = 'I am a string';
$anotherStr = "So am I";
```

Both of the above forms do the same thing: create a string with the contents set to the text inside the quotes. The difference between these two forms is that double-quoted strings have some extra features.

Variable Interpolation (Substitution)

Double-quoted strings allow the interpolation of variables. A variable inside a double-quoted string will be substituted for its value (with the caveat that the variable must exist in the same lexical scope as the string, naturally). The example below also uses the string concatenation operator `.` with the `PHP_EOL` constant, which outputs the appropriate newline sequence for your system – there's a lot more to come on those in this chapter. Here's the most important difference between the two quote styles:

```
$str = 'world';
print 'Hello $str' . PHP_EOL; // $str isn't interpolated
print "Hello $str" . PHP_EOL; // Value of $str is inserted into the string
```